

LECTURE POINTS

1. What is Foreign Policy?

Foreign policy means how a country **deals with other countries of the world**. It includes all the decisions, plans, and actions a country takes to protect its interests at the international level.

✓ In Very Simple Words:

Foreign policy tells us:

- How a country makes friends and alliances
- How it handles enemies or conflicts
- How it protects its security and economy
- How it improves its image and influence in the world

✓ What Does Foreign Policy Include?

Foreign policy is not only about politics. It covers many areas:

- **Political Relations**
→ Agreements, treaties, diplomatic visits, embassies
- **Economic Relations**
→ Trade, imports/exports, loans, foreign investment
- **Military Relations**
→ Defense agreements, arms deals, alliances
- **Cultural Relations (Soft Power)**
→ Education exchange, media, cultural programs

✓ Key Features:

- **Dynamic (Changing)**
→ Foreign policy changes according to global situations
(Example: Pakistan's shift from USA to China focus)
- **Interest-Based**
→ Every decision is made to protect national interest
- **Realistic and Practical**
→ Countries act according to benefit, not emotions

✓ Why is Foreign Policy Important?

- Protects the country from external threats and wars
- Helps in economic development through trade and aid
- Builds a good international image and reputation
- Helps solve conflicts through talks instead of war
- Increases global influence and power

Examples:

- Pakistan gets financial support from IMF and World Bank
- China invests in Pakistan through CPEC projects
- Countries impose sanctions when relations become bad

2. National Interest

National interest means what is most important and beneficial for a country. It is the main goal behind all foreign policy decisions.

✓ Types of National Interest:**1. Primary (Vital) Interests:**

These are the most important and cannot be ignored:

- Survival of the state
- Protection of borders
- National security and defense

👉 A country will do anything to protect these

2. Secondary Interests:

These are important but flexible:

- Trade and economic growth
- Diplomatic relations
- International reputation

👉 These can change over time

✓ Important Understanding:

- Every country first protects its own benefit
- Even friendly countries can become rivals if interests change

✓ Key Principle:

👉 “There are no permanent friends or enemies, only permanent interests.”

✓ Why National Interest is Important:

- It guides all foreign policy decisions
- Helps in choosing alliances and partnerships
- Explains why countries change policies over time

Examples:

- Pakistan supported USA in the Cold War for security and aid
- Later, Pakistan improved relations with China for economic growth
- Countries change trade partners for better benefits

3. Pakistan's Foreign Policy

After independence in 1947, Pakistan faced serious problems like weak economy, lack of resources, and security threats, especially from India.

✓ Main Goals:

- Protect sovereignty and territorial integrity
- Build a strong and stable economy
- Develop friendly relations with all countries
- Gain international recognition and respect
- Promote peace and cooperation

✓ Key Features:

- **Peaceful** → prefers dialogue over war
- **Flexible** → changes according to situation
- **Interest-Based** → focuses on benefits

✓ Phases:

- **Early Years** → depended on Western countries
- **Cold War Period** → joined alliances like SEATO and CENTO
- **Post-1971** → focused on rebuilding
- **Modern Era** → strong partnership with China (CPEC)

Examples:

- Pakistan joined the United Nations for global recognition
- Pakistan participates in UN peacekeeping missions
- CPEC projects improve infrastructure and economy

4. Indian Factor

India is the most important factor influencing Pakistan's foreign policy since independence.

✓ Reasons:

- Kashmir dispute
- Past wars and conflicts
- Border tensions
- Political and military rivalry

✓ Major Wars:

- 1948 → Kashmir conflict
- 1965 → Full-scale war
- 1971 → Bangladesh separation

✓ **Effects on Pakistan:**

- Strong focus on defense and military strength
- Need for alliances with powerful countries
- Continuous diplomatic efforts on Kashmir

✓ **Psychological Impact:**

- Feeling of insecurity
- Fear of Indian aggression

Examples:

- Line of Control tensions
- Nuclear tests by both countries in 1998
- Ongoing diplomatic efforts on Kashmir

5. Determinants of Foreign Policy

1. National Security

- Most important factor
- Includes protection from:
 - External threats (India)
 - Internal threats (terrorism)

👉 Pakistan spends heavily on defense

2. Economic Factor

- Strong economy = strong foreign policy
- Weak economy = dependence on others

✓ **Includes:**

- Trade agreements
- Foreign investment
- Loans and financial aid

Examples:

- IMF loans
- Trade partnerships
- CPEC economic projects

3. Ideological Factor

- Pakistan is based on Islamic ideology
- Promotes unity among Muslim countries

✓ But Also:

- Maintains relations with all countries
- Follows a balanced approach

4. Historical Factor

- Past conflicts influence present decisions
- Creates long-term mistrust

Example:

- India-Pakistan rivalry

5. Geographical Factor

- Pakistan is in an important location
- Connects South Asia, Central Asia, and Middle East

Example:

- Gwadar Port as a trade hub

6. Principles of Pakistan's Foreign Policy

1. Islamic Unity

- Strengthen relations with Muslim countries
- Promote cooperation and support

2. Good Relations with Neighbors

- Important for peace and development
- But difficult due to conflicts

3. Peace

- Avoid war
- Solve issues through dialogue

4. Self-Determination

- Support right of nations to decide their future

Examples:

- Kashmir
- Palestine

5. Peaceful Co-existence

- Respect sovereignty
- Avoid interference

6. United Nations

- Follow international law
- Participate in peacekeeping

7. Independent Policy

- Make decisions independently
- Balance relations with major powers

7. Foreign Policy Making

1. Leadership (Administrative Troika)

- Prime Minister
- President
- Army Chief

👉 They take major decisions

2. Foreign Ministry

- Handles diplomacy
- Manages relations with other countries

3. Intelligence Agencies

- Provide important security information
- Help in decision-making

4. Political Parties

- Influence foreign policy
- Represent public opinion

5. Parliament

- Debates foreign policy
- Ensures accountability

Conclusion

Pakistan's foreign policy focuses on:

- **Security** → protection from threats
- **Economy** → development and growth
- **Relations** → cooperation with other countries

✓ **Challenges:**

- Weak economy
- Conflicts with neighbors
- Dependence on foreign aid

✓ **Future Needs:**

- Strong and stable economy
- Peaceful relations with neighbors
- Independent and balanced policy
- Better global image

✓ **Final Thought:**

✍ A successful foreign policy needs:

- Strong leadership
- Clear national interest
- Public support
- Flexibility according to global changes

Strategic Significance of Pakistan

1. Introduction: Geo-Strategic Importance of Pakistan

Pakistan is considered one of the most important countries in the world because of its location. It is like a bridge connecting different regions, which increases its importance in global politics, trade, and security.

✓ **What is Geo-Strategic Location?**

Geo-strategic location means:

📍 A country's geographical position that makes it important for military, political, and economic reasons

✓ Why Pakistan's Location is Important?

Pakistan is important because:

- It connects South Asia, Central Asia, Middle East, and China
- It is close to oil-rich Middle Eastern countries
- It is near Central Asian countries that have gas and energy resources
- It shares borders with important countries like:
 - India (rival)
 - China (friend)
 - Afghanistan (conflict zone)
- It has access to the Arabian Sea, which is very important for trade

✓ Importance of Sea:

- Sea routes are cheaper for trade
- Ports help in import and export
- Increase economic opportunities

Example:

- Gwadar Port can connect China and Central Asia to international markets

✓ Two-Sided Impact:

Pakistan's location gives:

Advantages:

- Trade opportunities
- Foreign investment
- Strategic importance

Disadvantages:

- Foreign interference
- Security threats
- Involvement in global conflicts

2. External and Internal Challenges

Pakistan faces many problems due to its location and internal weaknesses.

External Challenges

External challenges come from outside the country.

✓ Main External Problems:

1. India

- Continuous rivalry since 1947
- Kashmir dispute
- Military competition

👉 India is the biggest external threat

2. Afghanistan

- Political instability
- Weak government
- Terrorism crossing the border

3. Global Powers

- Countries like USA, China, Russia influence Pakistan
- Pakistan sometimes becomes part of their competition

✓ Effects of External Challenges:

- Pressure on Pakistan's security
- Need to spend more on defense
- Dependence on powerful countries

Example:

- Pakistan became a frontline state in the War on Terror

Internal Challenges

Internal challenges are problems inside the country.

✓ Major Internal Problems:

- Political instability (frequent government changes)
- Weak institutions
- Poverty and unemployment
- Lack of education
- Corruption
- Ethnic and sectarian conflicts

✓ Effects:

- Weak economy
- Poor governance
- Security problems

Example:

- Political instability slows development projects like CPEC

3. Pakistan's Role in Global Conflicts

Pakistan has played an important role in major global conflicts because of its location.

Cold War Era

✓ What was Cold War?

- A conflict between USA and USSR
- No direct war, but political and military competition

✓ Pakistan's Role:

- Supported USA
- Joined Western alliances

✓ Why Pakistan Did This?

- Needed economic help
- Needed security against India

✓ Effects on Pakistan:

- Got military and economic aid
- Became dependent on USA
- Involved in global politics

Example:

- Pakistan joined SEATO and CENTO

War on Terror

✓ Background:

- 9/11 attacks in USA
- USA attacked Afghanistan

✓ Pakistan's Role:

- Supported USA
- Allowed military operations
- Provided bases and intelligence

✓ Why Pakistan Joined?

- Pressure from USA
- To avoid being declared enemy
- To get economic aid

✓ Negative Effects:

- Increase in terrorism
- Economic losses
- Social problems

4. War on Terrorism

✓ Major Impacts on Pakistan:

1. Terrorism Increased

- Rise of militant groups like TTP
- Frequent attacks in cities

2. Loss of Lives

- Thousands of civilians and soldiers died

3. Economic Damage

- Billions of dollars lost
- Investment decreased

4. Social Impact

- Fear and insecurity
- Religious extremism

Example:

- APS Peshawar attack showed seriousness of terrorism

✓ Pakistan's Response:

- Military operations (Zarb-e-Azb, Radd-ul-Fasaad)
- Border fencing
- Counter-terrorism policies

5. Afghan War and Its Impact

✓ Major Effects:

1. Afghan Refugees

- Millions came to Pakistan
- Increased burden on economy

2. Drug Trafficking

- Spread of drugs and crime

3. Terrorism

- Militancy spread into Pakistan

✓ Drone Attacks (More Detail):

- Conducted by USA
- Violated Pakistan's sovereignty
- Caused civilian deaths

✓ Importance of Afghanistan:

✍ Peace in Afghanistan = Peace in Pakistan

6. Post-US Withdrawal from Afghanistan

✓ Situation:

- USA left Afghanistan in 2021
- Taliban took control

✓ Effects on Pakistan:

- Border insecurity
- Fear of instability
- Risk of terrorism

✓ Important Point:

Pakistan cannot ignore Afghanistan because:

- Long shared border
- Direct impact on security

Example:

- Increase in cross-border attacks

7. Eastern Border: India Factor

✓ Nature of Conflict:

- Political rivalry
- Military competition
- Ideological differences

✓ **Kashmir Issue:**

- Core dispute between Pakistan and India
- People demand right of self-determination

✓ **Recent Developments:**

- India removed Article 370 (2019)
- Increased military control

✓ **Military Tensions:**

- Pulwama incident
- Balakot airstrike
- Pilot Abhinandan captured

✓ **Impact:**

- Continuous tension
- Risk of war
- Nuclear threat

8. Role of Global Powers

United States

✓ **Role:**

- Ally in Cold War and War on Terror

✓ **Problems:**

- Trust issues
- Pressure on Pakistan

China

✓ **Importance:**

- Strongest ally
- Supports Pakistan politically and economically

✓ **Key Projects:**

- CPEC

- Belt and Road Initiative

✓ **Importance of China:**

- Helps in economic development
- Balances India

✓ **Key Concept:**

👉 Pakistan balances relations between USA and China

9. Security Challenges

✓ **Major Problems:**

- Terrorism
- Extremism
- Border conflicts
- Proxy wars

✓ **Reasons:**

- Strategic location
- Weak internal system

Example:

- Afghanistan conflict increases terrorism in Pakistan

10. Opportunities for Pakistan

✓ **Economic Opportunities:**

- Trade routes
- Energy projects
- Foreign investment

✓ **Strategic Opportunities:**

- Become regional trade hub
- Act as bridge between regions
- Play role in peace talks

✓ **Importance of CPEC:**

- Roads and infrastructure
- Jobs and investment

- Economic growth

Conclusion

Pakistan's location is both a blessing and a challenge.

✓ Positive Side:

- Strategic importance
- Economic opportunities
- Global attention

✓ Negative Side:

- Security threats
- Foreign interference
- Regional conflicts

✓ Major Challenges:

- India conflict
- Afghanistan instability
- Terrorism

✓ Future Needs:

- Strong economy
- Political stability
- Better governance
- Independent foreign policy
- Peaceful relations

✓ Final Thought:

✍ Pakistan can become a strong country if it uses its location wisely with smart policies and stability